

Asia

The largest continent, Asia is also home to the world's largest city: Beijing, China. It is a continent of physical extremes, containing both the lowest point on Earth (the Dead Sea, in Jordan) and the highest point on Earth (Mount Everest, in the Himalayas) as well as vast deserts, Arctic tundra, tropical rainforests, and large river deltas.



TRANS-SIBERIAN RAILWAY

Spanning 5,717 miles (9,200 km), the Trans-Siberian Railway is one of the longest in the world. It runs eastward from Moscow, in western Russia (see page 239), through Siberia, and on to Vladivostok, close to Russia's border with China and North Korea. The line carries more than 200,000 cargo containers a year.



GREAT WALL OF CHINA

Begun in the third century BCE, the Great Wall is a series of fortified walls, towers, and ditches built and rebuilt over many centuries. Stretching about 13,000 miles (21,000 km) from North Korea to northwestern China, it was designed to repel foreign invaders from the north.

